

Rep. Tom Emmer on Fox and Friends

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LAWRENCE:

House Majority Whip Tom Emmer will be speaking at the GOP convention tonight, and he joins us live from Dallas. Congressman, it's good to see you. It looks like that the spark for the Republicans has always been the President of the United States. He knows how to get people to show up, and he knows how to get a crowd of people. How do you get that same type of spark for the other candidates that are running?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Good to be with you, Lawrence. Donald J. Trump has been the leader of this party for several years now. Despite what the people who don't like the President, despite what they want you to believe, he's as strong as ever, Lawrence. And the fact that he's here, you're right, he's the main attraction. He always is. He always will be. But his coattails are huge. You see it with his endorsements still to this day, again, despite these so-called polls, which are trying to say that his strength is waning. It's not. And I think this is going to be very interesting, Lawrence. This is a historic night. This is the first ever midterm convention, and he's going to make sure that he kicks us off in big fashion. And it's going to be, I believe, it's going to be a big push to November 3rd.

LAWRENCE:

You know, Congressman, they always say in politics, if you're explaining, you're losing. But Republicans have to explain away the inflation that was caused by the Democrats. How do you make that case to voters that Republicans are better suited for their bottom line?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Lawrence, you got to start pointing at all the great things that are happening in the economy. Did you see the jobs report a couple of days ago? That was almost as hot as the weather is down here in Dallas. I mean, you've got all kinds of great things happening in the economy, and that's what Republicans need to focus on. You brought it up at the opening of this segment. Most people believe that the Republicans are better positioned to address these issues than Democrats. And you don't need to get into the weeds, but we can remind people that gas was over \$5 under Joe Biden. We can tell people or remind them that he created 40-year highs in inflation. Donald Trump has been pulling the Biden economy out of the ditch with Republicans in the House and the Senate. And you're just starting to see the benefits of it, and it's going to be good.

LAWRENCE:

So, Congressman, according to our Fox Power ranking, it's giving Dems the edge of taking back the House. What's your message to voters? It looks like they need a spark. Turnout is going to be key. What's your case?

REP. TOM EMMER:

You just said the key word, turnout. That is what it's going to be. You've got to turn your people out. And historically, at a midterm, the party in the White House is not as energized as the party that lost the White House in the last presidential election. That's what you have to overcome. And you're going to see tonight, Republicans are energized, Lawrence. I was surprised when I got down here last night. We're going to have 20,000 to 30,000 people that are going to attend this event at the American Airlines Center. They are energized all over the place. So, again, it's about turnout. We've got to make sure that Republicans understand, despite these so-called experts, this thing is far from over. Remember, they told us we were going to lose as many as 24 seats in the House in 2020. We beat 12 Democrats that night, Lawrence, and we almost flipped the House. Two years later, they were telling us during a redistricting year that we were going to win this huge number of seats. They do this every two years, Lawrence. It's up to the voters, not the pollsters, to decide the outcome of this election. I'm really confident with Republicans being about common sense and Democrats being about communism, the contrast could not be greater. And I think that bodes well for Republicans in the fall.

LAWRENCE:

We'll see what happens, Congressman. Enjoy that barbecue in my home state. They'll show you a good time. Thank you, sir.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you, Lawrence.

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